

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a prize you would like to win

You should say:

- What it is
- How you heard about it
- What you would do to win it
- And explain why you would like to win it

To be perfectly honest, I'm not an ambitious person and I have absolutely no desire to win anything so what I am going to talk about is what I consider to be the ultimate prize in sport and that is the World Cup. I hope it's ok to talk about this hypothetical situation.

Obviously, I'm not a professional footballer and I'm guessing it is too late to start training to be one now so this prize is out of my reach, but if I were a pro footballer, then this would be my goal. In order to win it, I would undoubtedly need to train every day and dedicate my life to the sport. To play at the highest level, I would need to make a lot of sacrifices such as nights out, binging on fast food or convenience food and suchlike. Having a healthy and nutritious diet must be a priority. Although I tend to eat healthily, I absolutely love pizza so it would be hard for me to give up my favourite food. Mind you, if I wanted to be successful, I would have to make this sacrifice.

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I've been a football fan for as long as I can remember and one of my earliest memories is watching the World Cup. Sadly, in my lifetime, my country has never won the trophy; however, they won it in 1966 before I was born so it shows it can be done. In order to get picked for the national team, I would have to have a lot of talent, but also dedication. The best players are not always the most skilful, but they are usually the most dedicated to the sport.

If I trained day in day out and got a contract with a top team in the Premier League, then I would stand a good chance of being picked for the national team. The national team is a squad of the best players in England. Getting chosen for the squad would be hard enough, but then I would need to get picked for the team. If I were lucky enough, then I would be able to represent my country and win the most coveted trophy in the world – the World Cup.

PART 3

Should parents push their children to win prizes?

To be perfectly honest, I don't know. **I'm in two minds.**

My heart says no, kids should never be pushed, but...

...my head says that youngsters need to be taught **to have a winning mentality**, as the world is an incredibly competitive place and they need to know how to win.



Describe an exciting book you have read

You should say:

- What book it was
- What it was about
- Why you read this book
- And explain why you found it exciting

I'm pleased you've asked me this question because I'm an avid reader. The book I'd like to talk about is Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone. It was written by JK Rowling... I'm not entirely sure when, but I guess it was in the last decade. The book is the first novel in a series and these novels have been turned into movies.

The protagonist is Harry Potter and the other main characters in the book are Hermione and Ron. The plot is basically about a boy who learns on his eleventh birthday that he is the orphaned son of two powerful wizards and possesses unique magical powers of his own. He is taken away from his life as an unwanted child to become a student at Hogwarts, an English boarding school for wizards. There, he meets several other boarders who become his closest allies and help him discover the truth about his parents' mysterious deaths.

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The reason why I read this book was that it was recommended to me by my best friend. We tend to have similar tastes in literature, therefore, I was eager to read it after her recommendation.

Personally, I found it an incredibly delightful book to read and I loved the twist at the end. In addition, I enjoyed the setting of the book in a magical school. The author clearly has a vivid imagination and I highly recommend it.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a time you received bad service

You should say:

When it happened

Where you received it

Who you were with and what happened

And why the service was bad

To be perfectly honest, I feel that the standard of customer service has declined in my country over the last decade and I find I am frequently disappointed with the level of service received. I can recall a time recently though, when it was particularly poor and I have decided to talk about that time.

My family and I were dining out at a local restaurant which we had never been to before. We had booked the table for 7pm and arrived on time, only to be told that the table was not ready and there would be a 15-minute wait. We didn't have a problem with that and got a drink while we waited. One hour later, we were still waiting and starving. We were given more drinks and told that it would only be a short wait before our table was ready. With hindsight*, we should have left. However, we remained calm and patient and at 8.30, we were shown to our table. We ordered straightaway and expected the food to arrive shortly after. Half an hour later, two of the four starters arrived, which my children ate, and my husband and I sat and waited for ours.

By 9.30pm, our first courses still had not appeared so I said enough is enough. I called the waiter over and asked for the bill. He looked flustered and said 'your food is coming now'. Too late, I said. I was fuming by this point and just put some money on the table and left. We were all very hangry* and looked for the closest restaurant and saw a McDonald's over the road.

Within five minutes, we were eating burger and chips and it had never tasted as good. We never went to that restaurant again and, unsurprisingly, it closed down a few months later.

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*with hindsight = the ability to understand an event or situation only after it has happened

*hangry = hungry and angry – this is a new informal word that we have recently started using in English

Cue Card - Objects or Things

PART 3

What kinds of service are bad?

Well, restaurant service is the main one that I can think of that can often be poor. In many countries, **diners** are expected to **tip** if they receive good service; **yet**, nowadays, waiters expect a tip **regardless of** whether the service is good or bad. This means that the level of service **has dropped** significantly because tipping is **the norm** so the **servers** don't have to give particularly good service.

Why do some people choose to remain silent when they receive bad service?

I **guess that** they feel uncomfortable being **critical about** something. **For example**, if the food is bad in a restaurant and you complain, the chef might do something bad to your food such as **spit in it** so often we prefer to say nothing and just never go to that restaurant again.

Who should be responsible for bad service?

The manager is the person who should **take ultimate responsibility** because **he/she should have trained** the staff to provide good service. **Staff should be given** regular training in customer service to improve their **customer service skills**.

As a boss, what would you do to prevent bad service?

Training is the best way to try to prevent bad service. Many companies do not **invest in** training because it costs time and money, but this is **short-sighted*** because if you lose customers because of bad service then it is **costlier in the long run***.

If something is **short-sighted***, it means that the results of the actions haven't been considered e.g. **a short-sighted approach**

***in the long run** = over/after a long period of time

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe an article about health that you read in a magazine or on the internet

You should say:

- What it was
- When and where you read it
- Why you read it
- And explain how you felt about it

It was quite tricky to decide what to talk about because to be perfectly honest, I can't remember the last time I read a magazine and nothing immediately came to mind then I suddenly remembered reading an article on the BBC News website about veganism so I've decided to talk about that particular text.

I can't remember precisely when it was because I have a terrible memory for dates, but it was a couple of weeks back when I was trying to read more things in English to help me prepare for this IELTS exam. I was attracted to the article because of the image and the headline. It said something like 'McDonald's latest fast food chain to join vegan craze'. Apparently, in the UK, many people turn vegan in January and they call it 'Veganuary'. I am a foodie and am not keen on restaurant chains like McDonald's but I was interested to find out more about this diet craze because I strongly believe that in the future more people will follow plant-based diets.

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According to the article there has been an 80% uplift in the number of customers ordering vegetarian options. Many organisations, whose names escape me sorry, said that they are hoping that this move by McDonald's will help vegan foods to become/go mainstream*. In the past, it was tricky to find vegetarian options, let alone** vegan so hopefully other food outlets will follow suit***.

*to go/become mainstream =

Mainstream describes what's viewed by most people in a society as "normal," like the mainstream view that everyone should get married, move to the suburbs, and have children as soon as they can. Something that's mainstream is conventional, or the usual way of doing things

**let alone =

used to indicate that something is far less likely or suitable than something else already mentioned

***to follow suit =

To do the same thing as someone else

As for what I thought about it, well I found it quite thought-provoking and it made me think about my own diet choices and moreover, I enjoyed reading an article in English. It was fairly easy to follow and the images and graphics made it engaging and a good read. Oh, I think I may have forgotten to say where I read it, well, like I said, it was on the internet and I was commuting to work when I read it.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a historical building you have visited

You should say:

- Where it is
- What it looks like
- What it is used for now/what you learned there
- And explain how you felt about this building

To be perfectly honest, I haven't visited many historical buildings, mainly because I haven't had the opportunity, but there was one I went to when I was visiting London and I found it fascinating.

Prior to this visit, one of the things on my bucket list was to visit Buckingham Palace. I'm not a big fan of the monarchy/royal family, but it is a stunningly beautiful building and I am fascinated by architecture so during a trip to London last year, I made a point of visiting it. It is only open to the public for a few days in August and I was lucky enough to be in London at that time. Because of the limited opening times, it was essential to pre-book so I did this a few months in advance.

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During the visit, **we were given** a tour of **the state rooms**, which **are used** when the Queen is **entertaining guests**. **Obviously**, you can't go into her **private quarters**, but it is still **fascinating** and the rooms are **breath-taking**. We had **a guide** showing us around and she told us some **historical facts** about the building and **interesting info** such as there are 775 rooms inside the palace.

After the tour, we were **famished** so went to the café and had **a traditional English scone with jam and cream**. **Shortly after**, as **I was browsing** in **the gift shop**, **I spotted a tea cup** and I decided to buy it as **a souvenir** of my visit. It is **bone China** and a beautiful **pale pink** colour. I use it every morning for my tea and it is special because **it reminds me of** my visit to that **extraordinary** house. It **truly** is an **outstanding** building. The grand staircase is **spectacular** and that was **the highlight** of the visit for me.

PART 3

Why do people visit historical buildings?

I guess there could be **two main reasons** for this.

On the one hand, **some are fascinated by** history and want to find out about the **cultural value or historical significance** of the building.

For **others** though, it could be **simply for pleasure**. In my country, some old buildings have **free admission** so it's **a cheap day out**.



Describe something that make a lot of noise
Cue Card - Objects or Things

I have to say that it didn't take me long to **come up with** an answer to this question because this happened very recently so **it's still fresh in my mind***. The person or rather 'the thing' I am going to talk about is a dog that made **an awful lot of** noise a few weeks ago.

***to be fresh in your mind =** you can still remember it clearly

I was working in my office, which **is situated at** the front of my house and normally it's **fairly** quiet. **That particularly day,** **however,** a dog, and I'm not sure which one because there are **loads of** dogs in our **neighbourhood**, started **barking**. The first few times, I thought nothing of it, but then **I became more aware of it.** **Normally,** I listen to music when **I'm working** but that day **I was doing** something that I needed to **concentrate** on so **I was working in silence.**



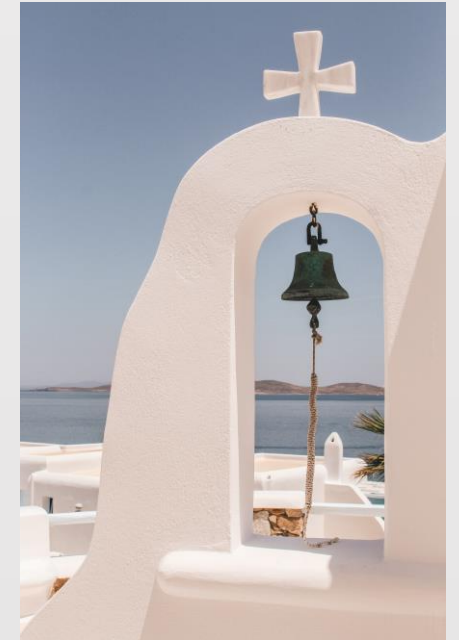
Cue Card - Objects or Things

After about 15 minutes of incessant barking though, I couldn't stand it anymore and I had to turn on some music to drown out the sound. I was starting to get a migraine with it – it was driving me mad*! The problem with any noise is that when you focus on it, you can't hear anything else. When I was growing up, we used to live near a church and every Thursday night, the bells rang, but honestly, I never noticed them, unless someone was visiting and they pointed them out. Then, I couldn't shut them out.

*to drive you mad = to really annoy you

Finally, to my great relief, the dog stopped barking and peace was restored. For a few days, every time I heard a bark, I was filled with dread**, but thankfully it hasn't happened again for such a long period.

**to be filled with dread = to have a strong negative feeling about something



Fluency and Coherence - Organisation
Grammatical Range and Accuracy - Grammar
Lexical Resource - Vocabulary

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a large company that you are interested in

You should say:

- What it is
- What the business does
- How you know about it
- And explain how you feel about it

The first company that came to mind is Apple, but to be perfectly honest, I'm not really into their products so I've decided to talk about one of their main rivals in the mobile phone business and that's Samsung.

Samsung is one of the world's leading electronic companies and it is based in Korea. If I remember rightly, it started as a grocery store, but switched to technology in the 1970s. I'm no expert on the history of this particular company so don't quote me! Anyway, the head office is located in Seoul; however, it is a multinational company. I'm pretty sure that Samsung accounts for something like 20% of South Korea's total exports so it is vital for the Korean economy.

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As for how I know about it, well I've been aware of the brand for ages, but I purchased one of its products for the first time a few weeks ago when the Samsung Galaxy BTS edition was launched. I'm a huge fan of the group BTS and when I saw the promo for the phone, I was influenced to buy it.

Because they have used BTS as their brand ambassadors*, I've taken a greater interest in their products. I think this is a great marketing move. Anything that BTS touches sells out so with quality products and eye catching adverts, this is a winning combination. I've been using the phone for a few weeks now and it is way better than my iPhone so I have a very positive opinion of this company. I think I'll stick with** them and buy more of their products in the near future.

*brand ambassadors = a person, especially a celebrity, who is paid to endorse or promote a particular company's products or services

**to stick with = to continue using or doing something

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a piece of software that you use often

You should say:

- What it is
- What you use it for
- How you got to know about it
- And explain why you use it

To be perfectly honest, I'm not entirely sure if the software that I'm going to talk about is classed as a piece of software or an application because I'm not an IT geek, but I know it's not hardware so I'm guessing it is software, anyway I've decided to talk about Microsoft Office.

For as long as I can remember, I've been using a version of Office and, in a nutshell*, it is indispensable. When I got my first PC, many years back, it came with an Office package and I've been utilising it ever since. As you're probably aware, there are various components such as word, excel and powerpoint and the others have slipped my mind*, but actually I don't use any of the other bits of it.

* In a nutshell = to say something in the fewest words possible

* To slip your mind = to forget

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Like I said, I mainly use three parts of Office – word for typing documents, excel for producing spreadsheets and powerpoint for presentations. I've been making use of it for years, but sadly I'm no expert and really I should go on a course to become more proficient. I'm just so snowed under with work that I struggle to get my work done so I don't have time to learn how to use it better. I know I should because if I became more IT/computer literate, then I would probably be able to get my work done more quickly.

With word and powerpoint, I'm an average user, but I'm pretty hopeless when it comes to excel. I wish I could use it better so I really should find time or make time to do a course. It would save me time in the long run because I waste hours trying to figure out how to do stuff in it. Mind you, despite being a satisfactory user of it at best, I couldn't live without it.

PART 3

Will instant messaging replace email?

My gut reaction is no, but who knows, it is hard to predict the future.

My reasoning for saying no is that with emails, you can attach documents, images etc, oh, **having said that though**, you can do that with messaging.

All the same, emails are more **formal** than messages and in certain situations, a bit of **formality** is **a must**.

For example, if you were contacting your boss on a weekend about **a work matter**, then an instant message might feel a bit **intrusive***.



*To be/feel intrusive = Something that is intrusive disturbs your mood or your life in a way you do not like

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**to stick with = to continue using or doing something

Describe a magazine that you like

You should say:

- What the magazine is
- When you started reading this magazine
- What the content is
- And explain why you like this magazine

The magazine that I would like to talk about is called 'FourFourTwo'.

It takes its name from the football formation of the same name, 4-4-2. This magazine is published once a month and as the title suggests it is all about football. The major reason why I enjoy reading this sports mag is that for the most part the articles are in-depth so you find out a lot about legendary or up-and-coming football players.

I'm not entirely sure when I first started reading it. If I remember rightly, my parents bought me a subscription to it for my birthday a few years ago. I love it so much that I have renewed the subscription every year. It is great value for money because it's jam-packed with articles and insightful info.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Some **glossy** magazines are full of adverts and this can be quite annoying because there isn't much **content**, but what I love about this **mag** is that **although** there are adverts, they are not on every other page. **They tend to be** just at the back of the magazine.

One particular article that I read recently was about Cristiano Ronaldo and **rather than just concentrating on** his **accomplishments** and his celebrity lifestyle, this article **discussed in depth** how he **trains**, what he eats etc and, **therefore**, I found it **a fascinating insight** into what makes him an **incredible** footballer.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a piece of advice you received at work or for your studies

You should say:

- What it was
- Who you received it from
- What you did after receiving it
- And explain how you felt about it

There is one piece of advice that I was given a while back and it is something that I try to follow whenever I am doing anything and that is 'done is better than perfect'. For as long as I can remember I have been a perfectionist. I'm never satisfied with anything and I have to re-do it or tweak it to make it better. The problem with this is that often things never get finished because I'm too busy striving for perfection.

I can't remember precisely when it was, but when I was working on a project with a former colleague, I was becoming increasingly stressed because the deadline was looming and we still had loads to do. The reason why we weren't making much progress was because I kept going back and tweaking what we had done rather than moving forward and finishing the project. My perfectionism was driving my colleague mad and so he said to me 'you know, I really admire your desire to have the perfect end product, but done is better than perfect'.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

When he first said it, I thought to myself 'what utter nonsense' but then when I reflected on it later, I realised he was right and this was incredibly useful and constructive advice. If I carried on changing minor details, it wasn't going to add much to the finished product, but an unfinished project would certainly get us in trouble with our superiors/the higher-ups.

When I went into work the next day, I had a much more positive attitude and focused on the finish line. Thanks to my workmate's sage advice, we got everything done with a day to spare and then I was able to make some final adjustments. I now try to follow this advice as a rule*. Previously, I suffered from a fear of failure and that stopped me from finishing things. Some days I do need to repeat the mantra** 'done is better than perfect' many times, but I am a million times better than I was at getting things done.

*as a rule = usually but not always

**a mantra = a statement or slogan repeated frequently

PART 3

Why do young people find it hard to make career choices?

Well, there are multiple reasons for this, but I'll highlight a few of these.

Firstly, youngsters often dream of becoming a pro footballer or a YouTuber, but these dreams are squashed by parents or teachers who tell them they are unrealistic. For some, they have no other desires and don't know what to do.

Secondly, the job market is in a pretty dire situation globally so lack of jobs in many fields makes a difficult decision even trickier.

Finally, many never know what they want to do in life so making those choices at 16 or 18 is virtually impossible.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a piece of good news you heard (from the TV or the Internet)

You should say:

- What the news was about
- When you heard this news
- Where you heard this news from
- And explain why you think it was a piece of good news

To be perfectly honest, I was struggling to think of a piece of good news because sadly, at the moment, the world is a dark place and we are bombarded with stories about murders and suchlike on a daily basis. However, then I suddenly remembered the heartwarming story of the Thai footballers who were trapped in a cave and all came out alive.

I can't recall precisely when it was, but it wasn't that long ago. The boys had been exploring the cave on a school trip. From memory, I think they were all teens, but they might have been a bit younger. Anyway, they had gone into the cave with their group leader and whilst they were in there, the water at the entrance of the cave started rising and they were trapped. They were stuck in there for a few days and the whole world was watching them and praying for them to get out.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

As for where I first heard about it... it would have been on Twitter – I would have seen it trending on Twitter and clicked on a news story to find out more. Again, I am not entirely sure of the exact details, but I believe it was two British divers and a few others who made the precarious journey of going into the cave and trying to rescue them. The rescue operation lasted a few days and not only were the boys lives at risks, but also the lives of their rescuers.

Fortunately, and amazingly, there was a happy ending and all the trapped boys came out alive. I cried tears of happiness when they emerged out of the cave. It was a remarkable story and those who saved their lives are real heroes.

PART 3

Do you think children should start watching news from a young age?

I was going to say 100% yes,

and then I hesitated because the news is full of heartbreaking stories with graphic images.

I strongly believe that the young should not be exposed to such things so I have changed my mind and think, absolutely not.

PART 3

Why do some people like to share news on social media?

There is a tendency nowadays to share everything so if something is newsworthy they will share it.

Some like to share their personal news such as the birth of a child because it is convenient and faster than trying to contact all their contacts.

I feel that there is a tendency to overshare nowadays and things that you posted as a teen may come back to haunt you so I think sharing should be done with caution.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

How do people in your country get news?

Nowadays, for the younger generation, it is mainly online. Twitter is a main source of news for many, as it is so up-to-date. However, I wouldn't say it is the most reliable source. I guess the older generation prefer old-fashioned methods such as the TV, radio and newspapers.

What kinds of news do people in your country like?

In the main, I guess that they are more interested in domestic news rather than international news. This is most likely because it affects them more closely. I would say that the majority of people are interested in sports news. Many are into football so they want to know results, transfers, team news and so on.

What kinds of good news do people like to hear?

Any good news, I suppose... In particular, stories where someone has overcome something so a story that started off bad and then had a happy ending. I think this is probably more heartening than a story about a huge lottery win.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a piece of clothing you enjoy wearing

You should say:

- What it is
- Where you bought it
- How often you wear it
- And explain why you enjoy wearing it

I guess this is probably true for a lot of people... my wardrobe is jam-packed full of clothes, but I tend to wear a small proportion of them because they are what I feel most comfy in. My old favourite is a hoodie that I've had for a good number of years now so I've decided to talk about that item of clothing.

I can't remember exactly when I got it, but it was roughly five years ago. It was given to me by my parents on my birthday so it does have sentimental value, but the main reason for wearing it is comfort and practicality. In terms of colour, it's plain black with a logo on the front and there is some writing on the back as well. I'm not into wearing loud colours so I tend to wear a lot of black and the good thing about this hoodie is that it goes with everything so no matter what I am wearing, it matches. Sadly, because it has been washed so many times, the colour has faded so I tend to wear it more when I'm chilling at home nowadays. My mum/dad/wife/husband keeps threatening to throw it away because it looks so washed out.

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Like I said, I usually only put it on at home now, but that is pretty much day in day out. The only time I don't wear it is when it's in the wash. When I get new things, I'm scared to wear them because I don't want to spill anything on them and get a stain on them, whereas with older clothes, I don't care as much so I think this is the major reason why I live in it because I'm not worried about spillages.

My mum actually bought me another one to replace this one because she was sick of seeing me in it, but it's not as comfortable as my old one, as the fabric feels stiff. One of these days, I will have to switch over and start wearing it, but for the time being I am going to continue wearing this washed out and beloved one.

PART 3

What's the difference in the style of dressing between young and old people?

In the past, I guess there was a clear difference between them with the young wearing casual, trendy stuff,

whereas the oldies tended to wear old-fashioned, formal clothes.

Nowadays, though, the boundaries have blurred* and all clothing styles are accessible to everyone and it would be wrong to stereotype one group as being casual and the other as being smart.



to blur the boundaries* = to have fewer differences between things



Describe a practical skill you learned recently

You should say:

- What it was
- When you learned it
- Why you learned it
- And explain how you felt about it

I was struggling to think of what to talk about for this topic because I haven't learned any practical skills recently, as far as I can remember, but I did learn how to make chocolate brownies a few years ago so I've decided to talk about that.

I've always been a pretty decent cook, but I tend to cook savoury things like curry, pasta and suchlike as I don't really have a sweet tooth. A year or so ago, I invited a few mates around for a meal to celebrate my birthday and you can't really have a dinner party without a pudding so I decided to have a go at making something. As it was my first attempt at making something sweet, I didn't want to be too ambitious and make something really fancy so that's why I chose brownies – they're fairly simple to make and they seem to be popular and liked by most people.

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Although these are somewhat straightforward, I made triple chocolate brownies so they were slightly more complex than a plain chocolate brownie. And I'd like to add that there is an art to cooking brownies – if you undercook them, they are too runny and if you overcook them, they are too dry.

I was delighted with my first attempt because they were spot on – not too runny nor too dry. All of the guests complimented me and said they were the best brownies they had ever tasted. I would like to say that I have progressed onto making other desserts, but that would be a lie.

Every time I need to cook something sweet, I make the same brownies – they are my signature dish. Hopefully, in the near future, I will try and make a few other things – I'd love to make a lemon tart, but I'm so snowed under with work at the moment so it'll have to wait.

PART 3

What are the most important skills in modern society?

Off the top of my head, being able to cook is vital.

Firstly, for your health's sake, you need to eat healthy and nutritious meals rather than convenience food, processed foods and take-aways.

And secondly, everyone is tightening their belts* to save money and eating out or buying ready meals all the time costs a fortune.



*to tighten your belt = to reduce your spending

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a newly built public facility (such as a park, cinema etc) that influences your city

You should say:

Where this facility is

When it was built

What people can do there

What influence this facility has

To be honest, I was struggling to think of a new public facility because there is not a great deal of development happening where I live. After the economic downturn in the last decade, a lot of development and redevelopment stopped because there is no public funding for such things. For that reason, I am going to talk about an existing public swimming pool, which has been around for many years now, but has undergone a period of renovation in the last couple of years.

I can't recall precisely when it was built – it was quite a while ago, but like I said, it has been revamped. Because it was an ancient building, it needed a lot of TLC and it was becoming a risk to the public so the local council decided to close it down. When the general public heard that it was at risk of closure, there was a public outcry and people started a petition to keep it open. The reason why it is a much-loved place is that there are very few places in my town that are publicly-funded and few can afford to go to the expensive, flashy pools and gyms in the city. The entrance cost was cheap and for those on a limited budget, it was a great place to take your kids in the school holidays.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

When the local council realized how **furious** people were about **the proposed closure**, they decided to see if they could find a way to keep it open. There were **some fundraising activities** and a number of local businesses **donated money**. **Within a short space of time – roughly** six months – **enough money had been raised to get the repairs done**. **Not only that**, but there was money left to buy some new equipment for **the fitness centre**.

These **renovations** have **vastly improved** the place and it has become more popular with not just families, but people in their twenties who use the gym to get fit.

PART 3

What measures should be taken to deal with damage to public facilities?

Nowadays, damage or vandalism on any public property or private property is not taken as seriously as it should be.

Sadly, the police **are snowed under with work** and are dealing with more serious crimes so vandalism often gets overlooked.

I feel that we should have **a zero-tolerance policy** and the costs of any repairs should be paid by **the perpetrator** of the damage.



PART 3

What's the difference between facilities in the countryside and the ones in the cities?

Obviously, the major difference is that there are very few facilities **in rural areas**.

Public facilities are not built in villages because there is not enough **footfall*** and it would be a waste of money.

In a major city, you can find everything from swimming pools to libraries, but such places are **non-existent** outside of **urban areas**.

***footfall** = the number of people entering a business, shop or shopping area in a given time

Cue Card - Objects or Things

What are the differences between old facilities and new facilities?

Well, newer facilities are more modern and are likely to have the latest equipment. The cost of maintaining old buildings and equipment is astronomical, therefore, they tend to get run down very quickly.

What facilities do young people and old people like in your country?

In the main, the old like public libraries because they don't have tablets or kindles and tend to still read books and newspapers. The young access everything on their gadgets and don't tend to frequent such places. The younger generation are more into gyms and fitness places because they are obsessed with keeping fit.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a change you would like to see in your local area

You should say:

- What it is
- What needs to be done
- What difficulties there may be
- And explain why you feel it is important

It was quite tricky to decide what to talk about because there are loads of things I find annoying and frustrating about where I live, but I've decided to talk about one of my biggest bugbears* and that is traffic congestion.

*a bugbear = a thing that causes fear, anxiety, or irritation

I guess this is not a localized problem and it is one that most people struggle with on a daily basis, especially those who live in urban areas. Nowadays, many commute to work and are faced with the problem of traffic jams. I have a 30-minute commute to work, but because I am making that journey during rush hour, it can take up to two hours to get to work. Not only am I late for work, but when I arrive, I'm in a bad mood** because I have been stuck in traffic for so long. For me, using public transport is not an option because my house isn't located near to a bus or train station.

**to be in a bad mood = to feel annoyed or angry

Cue Card - Objects or Things

As for what needs to be done, well I'm in two minds about what should be done. On the one hand, the road network and infrastructure* need to be expanded to accommodate the number of cars on the road; however, that would be bad for the environment, so I suppose investment in the public transport network is required.

*infrastructure = the basic physical and organizational structures and facilities (e.g. buildings, roads, power supplies) needed for the operation of a society or enterprise

Extra funding for public transport is essential and, in addition to that, the cost of using it needs to be lowered because it currently costs a fortune so there is no incentive** to use it. It should be subsidised*** by the government, mind you the government is so strapped for cash**** that it is unlikely to happen. It must be done though because all of the vehicles on the road is incredibly harmful for the environment.

**incentive = a thing that motivates or encourages someone to do something

***to be subsidised = to pay part of the cost

****to be strapped for cash = to not have enough money

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a job you would not like to do in the future

You should say:

- What it is
- Where you know about it from
- What is bad about the job
- And explain you wouldn't like to do it

It was quite tricky to decide what to talk about because it's not something I've ever thought about before so nothing immediately came to mind so I'm going to talk about the first job that popped into my head.

I've chosen being the Prime Minister. In terms of what this role entails*, well the PM leads the country. He/she is the leader of their political party and if their party wins the election then he/she is appointed as the Prime Minister. Despite having one of the most important jobs in the country, if not the most important role, the salary is relatively small. I'm not entirely sure of the exact figure, but I believe it's around £150k. Don't get me wrong, that's way more than the average salary, but some Premier League footballers get paid around £300k a week so the PM is paid a pittance** in comparison.

*to entail = to involve

**a pittance = a very small amount of money

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Besides the pay, the working conditions aren't great. Now, I don't know for certain, but I'm guessing it's not a nine-to-five job. It's more like a 24/7 job. Even when the PM is on holiday, it must be hard to switch off and completely forget about work.

There are numerous reasons why I would loathe this position, but primarily, it seems to be a thankless task. Every PM in every country faces criticism on a daily basis and it is virtually impossible to keep everyone happy. I think you need to have a thick skin* to be able to do it and that's the major reason why I'd be unsuitable. I get easily offended** and I couldn't stand the constant criticism. Even if you are not a fan of your PM, you need to respect them because they have a lot to put up with***.

*to have a thick skin = to not be sensitive to criticism or insults

**to get easily offended = to get upset by what others say to/about you

***to put up with = to accept or continue to accept an unpleasant situation or experience; to tolerate

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a uniform you wear (at your school or company)

You should say:

- What it is
- When and where you wear it
- What it looks like
- And explain how you feel about it

It was quite tricky to decide what to talk about because I don't wear a uniform for my job so I was struggling to think of what to say but I used to wear a school uniform so I've decided to talk about that and hope that's ok.

I can't remember precisely which year it was because I have a terrible memory for dates, but it was many years back when I was studying in secondary school. A uniform was compulsory for all students and it consisted of* a pair of black trousers/skirt, a white shirt/blouse, a tie and a blazer. On the top pocket of the blazer there was the school emblem, a bit like a logo. For PE, there was also a uniform, basically a white polo shirt and shorts. I was always losing my PE kit and my mum would hit the roof**!

**to hit the roof = To get very angry and annoyed

*to consist of = to be made of or formed from something

Cue Card - Objects or Things

As for how I felt about it... this is tricky and I'm in two minds*. On the one hand, there are a variety of reasons why this uniform was a good thing. Firstly, kids can be cruel and if you're not wearing designer trainers or keeping up with the latest fashion trends then you get teased so there was none of that. As well as that, it took much less time to get ready because I didn't have to agonise over* what I was going to wear each day. On the other hand though, I hated wearing a blazer, no actually it was much stronger than that I loathed/couldn't stand*** it. Another thing is that when it was in the wash and my mum forgot to wash it or I had got it dirty then I didn't always have a spare. There were many mornings when I was in a panic because I couldn't find a clean shirt. Uniforms are worn to unify people, to bring them together and make everyone the same, but the downside of that is that all individuality is killed and teens, in particular, should be free to express themselves so that's another thing I couldn't stand. I hated having to conform****.

*to be in two minds = to be unable to decide about something

**to agonise over = to worry excessively, especially about a decision

***to loathe/can't stand = really hate

****to conform = comply with rules, standards, or laws

Describe a building that you like

You should say:

- Where it is
- What it looks like
- What it is used for
- And explain why you like or dislike it

I'm pleased you've asked me this question because I'm fascinated by architecture. I particularly love old buildings and think that in the past we used to create much more interesting buildings than we do today. I feel that architecture has taken a step backwards. Profit is the most important thing nowadays so developers build buildings as quickly and as cheaply as possible with no care for durability or aesthetics.

One of the most iconic buildings in the world for many years has been the Empire State Building in New York. The soaring Art Deco skyscraper was, for decades, the tallest structure on Earth and it has featured in countless photographs and films (including, of course King Kong). It stood as the world's tallest building for more than forty years, from its completion in 1931 until construction of the World Trade Centre's North Tower was completed in 1972. Following the destruction of the World Trade Centre in 2001, the Empire State Building once again became the tallest building in New York City.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

I first saw this building in films and **vowed** that one day I would visit it. In 1999 I went on a trip to New York with my mum and sister and **one of the highlights of our trip** was going to the top of the Empire State Building at night. The view over Manhattan was amazing and I felt like I was in a film. The whole of the skyline was **illuminated**. In 2004 I went to New York again, this time with my husband, and **we made a point of going** to see this building again.

As far as I am aware the building **is used** as offices. **I am not entirely sure what** businesses there are **though**. Because it is such an **iconic** building and **has been used** in so many photographs, films etc. it is an extremely popular tourist attraction. I remember on both occasions that I went to see this building there were long **queues**. **I have to say though** that **it was worth the wait**.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

Describe a Gift you have received

When I was growing up, I used to love birthdays and special occasions such as Christmas, as I would get all the toys and books that I had asked for, but as you get older, you have everything you need so it becomes tricky for people to find suitable gifts. Because of this, whenever I am given a present now, it is often money or a gift card. Gift cards are great to receive but then you are limited to where you can spend them whereas with cash you can choose where you spend it.



It was my birthday last month and my parents kept pestering me to tell them what I wanted, but as usual there was absolutely nothing that I wanted or needed so I said I don't need anything. Obviously, close family would not feel comfortable with giving me nothing so on my birthday there were a few small gifts such as chocolates and suchlike, but my main present was money. I won't say how much it was because it is vulgar* to talk about money, isn't it?

*tasteless; lacking sophistication or good taste

Fluency and Coherence - Organisation
Grammatical Range and Accuracy - Grammar
Lexical Resource - Vocabulary

Cue Card - Objects or Things

I was **delighted** to receive it because **I have been saving up** for my holiday and this money will help pay for the holiday and there will be some **left over** for spending money. I do feel bad because my parents aren't particularly **well-off**, but I know that if I refused the money **they would be hurt and offended** so I **gratefully** accepted it. I thanked them at the time and then a few days later, I sent them a thank you card because I wanted to show them that I was **extremely grateful** to them.

I feel that when someone gives you money as a present, it is important to buy something special or do something with it such as go on holiday **rather than wasting it on** things such as online gaming. My brother does this and **it infuriates me** because it is my parents' **hard-earned money** and he just **squanders** it on Fortnite. My holiday will be special and I will buy my parents something when I am there to thank them again for this gift.



Describe a useful skill that you learned in a maths class

class You should say:

- What the skill was
- How you learned it
- Who taught you it
- And explain why you think it was useful for you

If I remember rightly, one of the first things we learnt in maths was mental arithmetic. This basically means doing maths calculations in your head. Obviously, the first time we were shown how to do this, we used fingers to carry out these sums; however, this led onto doing calculations such as $37 + 45$ in your head, without the need for a calculator.

Initially, I found such sums quite tricky and they would take a long time, but through hard work and perseverance I became much more adept at doing these. At first, I used to think, why do we need to do these complex calculations in our head when we could use a calculator instead; when I got my first job in my teens, the value of this skill became apparent.

Cue Card - Objects or Things

When I was still studying in high school, I got a part-time job in a café and as well as serving customers, I had to **add up** their **bills**, as there was only one **cash register** and it was more **convenient** to **do it by hand**. Often the customer **was standing or sitting** in front of me and waiting for me to **calculate** the bill and I needed to do it **asap**. Having this skill of being able to **mentally** add large numbers in my head made life so much easier.

Although it was my first teacher, **whose name escapes me at the moment**, who taught me how to do this, the hours of practice I had **whilst working** in the café really made me quite **proficient** at this skill.